



bench

സാധാരണ ജീവിതം അസാധാരണ ശ്രദ്ധ

Monthly Newsletter

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BENCH FELLOWSHIP PROGRAM REPORT

Session 4



The Bench Fellowship is a part-time program tailored for first-year MSW students in Kerala, spanning 45 to 60 days over an 18-month period. This innovative initiative aims to unearth and nurture exceptional qualities in young individuals, empowering them to make a meaningful impact within their communities.

- Assumption College, Changanacherry
- St. Thomas College, Thavalappara
- St. Gregorios College, Parumala

PARTICIPATING COLLEGES



The 4th session of the Bench Fellowship camp was held from June 6-8, 2025, at the Maramon Retreat Centre in Kozhenchery. The session focused on the topic "Re-imagining Development: Ground-Level Approach to Social Change" and was led by Vidya AP, a SBI Fellow for 2023-2024.



DAY 1: WHAT IS SOCIAL WORK

The camp commenced on the evening of June 6th, with 17 students in attendance. Jibin P B facilitated the first session, where fellows shared their fieldwork experiences as part of their curriculum. The discussions revealed a range of experiences, with some fellows expressing satisfaction and others dissatisfaction with their fieldwork.

Following the sharing session, a facilitator led a discussion on the topic of social work. He posed the question, "What is social work?" and, after allowing some deliberation, provided an answer that social work deals with human beings. The session also covered the Whole Person Paradigm, which helps in understanding individuals. This concept was drawn from Stephen R. Covey's book, "The 8th Habit."

THE 8TH HABIT



Under Jibin's expert guidance, participants immersed themselves in interactive discussions exercises, games, and activities.

The day concluded with a period of silence and reflection, during which participants expressed gratitude for the day's experiences. This introspective moment allowed fellows to appreciate the value of the camp and its impact on their personal and professional growth.



DAY 2: RE-IMAGINING DEVELOPMENT

GROUND-LEVEL APPROACH TO SOCIAL CHANGE

The second day of the camp began with a serene hour of meditation and silence at 6:30 a.m. Following breakfast, Vidya AP, the main facilitator, led the session on the topic "Re-imagining Development: Ground-Level Approach to Social Change."

- Storytelling and Privileges Exercise - Vidya AP initiated the session with a storytelling exercise, dividing the fellows into three-member groups to share their personal stories
- Sharing of SBI Fellowship Experience - Inspiring Stories from Rajasthan.
- Drama Session - Workshop and Presentation
- PRA Tools Session - introduced the Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA) tools, focusing on three key tools: Historical Transects, Resource Mapping, and Timeline Analysis.



HIGHLIGHTS



Reflection and Evaluation

After the drama session, the fellows reflected on the activities and evaluated their experiences. They appreciated the opportunity to develop healthy relationships, improve their confidence levels, and showcase their acting skills. The day concluded with a period of silence and gratitude, allowing the fellows to introspect and appreciate the value of the camp.

DAY 3: SEVEN HABITS OF HIGHLY EFFECTIVE PEOPLE

The third and final day of the camp began with a 30-minute session of meditation and silence at 6:30 a.m. Following this, Jibin P B led a session on the "7 Habits of Highly Effective People," drawing from Stephen R. Covey's book of the same name. Provided a concise overview of each habit, highlighting their relevance to both personal and professional life.

After breakfast, the facilitator engaged the fellows in various group activities that can be applied when working with children and youth. These activities aimed to enhance the fellows' skills and confidence in their interactions with these age groups.

HIGHLIGHTS



CONCLUSION

Before concluding the camp, the fellows provided feedback and suggestions on the entire camp experience. They expressed their satisfaction with the camp, noting improvements in their confidence, communication skills, and ability to form healthy relationships with their peers.



Key Achievements:

The 4th session of the Bench Fellowship camp came to a close after the fellows wrote down their gratitude and reflections. The camp provided a valuable opportunity for the fellows to learn, grow, and bond with each other, and they departed with newfound insights and skills to apply in their personal and professional lives.